Omar Ba Raean

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SOC ANALYST

Motivated software engineering graduate from KFUPM with a concentration in cybersecurity and blockchain, certified in Security+, SC-900, and AWS Cloud Practitioner. Over 1 year of hands-on home lab experience with Splunk, Wazuh, Sysmon, and Wireshark in security monitoring, alert triage, and incident investigation. Solid knowledge of information security, network security, operating systems, and security policies, with strong analytical and problem-solving skills, a willingness to learn, and fluency in Arabic and English.

WORK EXPERIENCE

SDAIA-KFUPM Joint Research Center for AI • **Dhahran, Saudi Arabia** • **07/2024 - 09/2024**

Software Developer and AI Trainer

- Reduced a 50-question Big Five personality test by 80% while still measuring all five traits, using factor analysis on response data from over 1 million participants to identify the most informative questions.
- Built a full-stack web application using TypeScript, Next.js, and MongoDB that scores users' personalities based on the test and calculates compatibility between riders when they schedule a trip by time and destination.

EDUCATION

B.Sc. in Software Engineering with a concentration in Cybersecurity and Blockchain

King Fahd University of Petroleum and Minerals (KFUPM) • Dhahran, Saudi Arabia • GPA: 3.458 / 4.0

CERTIFICATIONS

Security+ • CompTIA

Microsoft Certified: Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals (SC-900) • Microsoft

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner • Amazon Web Services

CS50: Introduction to Cybersecurity • Harvard

Cyber Genius 1.0 (Inside the Breach and Beyond Trust Boundaries challenges) • Microsoft

PROJECTS

Hather: On-Device Arabic/English Scam Detection with a Distilled LLM

Built an on-device Arabic/English scam detector for SMS and WhatsApp: a rules engine plus a small LLM (0.8B), distilled from a 27B model, that matched its teacher on 533 real, hand-labelled messages.

Hybrid Home Lab

Built a hybrid AWS/on-premise lab simulating enterprise security operations, monitoring network, endpoint, and system activity and applying log analysis, alert triage, and incident investigation workflows to practise escalation and documentation aligned with standard SOC playbooks and best practices.

SOC Automation Platform

Building a Python automation layer on Wazuh for alert triage, incident enrichment, and response orchestration, streamlining alert management and reducing the manual steps required before an alert reaches an analyst for investigation.

SIEM and Honeypot Analysis

Deployed Wazuh (SIEM/XDR) alongside a honeypot to divert attacker activity away from a production server, analysing the captured activity to test how effectively honeypots strengthen network security by keeping attackers away from the main server.

SKILLS

SIEM & Detection: alert triage, log analysis, reporting & documentation, security monitoring, Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk, Sysmon, Wazuh

Detection Engineering: Alert tuning, detection validation against packet capture, false-positive reduction

Networking: network switches, Nmap, pfSense, SMTP, TCP/IP, Wireshark

Endpoint & IR: Active Directory, Entra ID (identity and access management), EDR concepts, Microsoft Defender XDR, incident response, incident triage, phishing analysis

Security Assessment: compliance (Microsoft Purview), security policies, security recommendations, threat research, vulnerability assessment, Zero Trust

OS & Cloud: AWS, Bash, Linux, Windows Server

AI & ML: AI security and governance, dataset curation and labelling, GGUF quantization, Kaggle GPUs, llama.cpp, LLM distillation, LoRA fine-tuning (Unsloth)

Programming Languages: Java, JavaScript, Next.js, Python, TypeScript

Languages: Arabic (native), English (fluent)